

Building Permit Cost Estimate

160 Still Forest Dr, Cedar Creek TX 78612
Commercial Building Permit — Bathroom Building (17' x 17', 2-Story)
Prepared: March 17, 2026

Address: 160 Still Forest Dr, Cedar Creek, TX 78612 (Bastrop County, unincorporated)

Lot Size: 1.73 acres (75,499 sq ft)

Structure: 17' x 17' two-story bathroom building (1st floor: 2 toilets + shower; 2nd floor: storage)

Occupancy: Commercial (lodging amenity — shared guest bathroom)

Owner: Revocable Trust of Subhash Sonnad

Phase A — Design Professionals

Task	Code	Low	High	Midpoint	Notes
Licensed Architect	A1	\$3,000	\$6,000	\$4,500	TX Registered Architect; small commercial
Structural Engineer (PE)	A2	\$2,000	\$4,000	\$3,000	Foundation + framing for 2-story
Geotechnical / Soil Report	A3	\$1,500	\$3,000	\$2,000	Soil borings for foundation design
Architectural Plans	A4	\$0	\$0	\$0	Included in architect fee (A1)
Structural Plans	A5	\$0	\$0	\$0	Included in structural engineer fee (A2)
MEP — Mechanical (HVAC)	A6	\$1,000	\$2,500	\$1,500	Small commercial HVAC design
MEP — Electrical	A7	\$800	\$2,000	\$1,200	Lighting, panels, NEC compliance
MEP — Plumbing	A8	\$800	\$2,000	\$1,200	2 toilets + shower; tie to existing OSSF
Design Subtotal		\$9,100	\$19,500	\$13,400	

Phase B — Compliance & Technical Studies

Task	Code	Low	High	Midpoint	Notes
Fire Protection / Suppression Plan	B1	\$1,500	\$4,000	\$2,500	Sprinkler + fire alarm per IFC
TDLR Accessibility Registration	B2	\$250	\$500	\$375	State registration fee; required for all commercial
ADA / TAS Compliance Review	B3	\$500	\$1,500	\$1,000	Accessible restroom + routes design
Energy Code (IECC / COMcheck)	B4	\$300	\$800	\$500	COMcheck report; often included w/ architect
Drainage Plan (PE-signed)	B5	\$0	\$0	\$0	Carried over from development permit
Erosion & Sediment Control	B6	\$0	\$500	\$250	May be bundled with drainage

Site / Civil Plans Update	B7	\$500	\$1,500	\$1,000	Update existing site plan for building footprint
Parking & Traffic Analysis	B8	\$0	\$500	\$250	Small project; may not be required
Septic Capacity Verification	B9	\$500	\$1,500	\$1,000	Verify existing Jet J-500 supports added load
Elevation Certificates	B10	\$0	\$0	\$0	Zone X — not in floodplain
Compliance Subtotal		\$3,550	\$10,800	\$6,875	

Phase C — Application & County Fees

Task	Code	Low	High	Midpoint	Notes
Development Application Fee	C1	\$1,000	\$2,500	\$1,750	Based on construction cost; check county schedule
Proof of Ownership (Deed)	C2	\$0	\$0	\$0	Already on file from development permit
Updated Survey / Plat	C3	\$0	\$500	\$250	May need update to show building footprint
Compile Sealed Plans Package	C4	\$0	\$0	\$0	No additional cost; compilation task
TDLR Review Approval	C5	\$0	\$0	\$0	No additional fee beyond B2 registration
Release of Easement	C6	\$0	\$500	\$0	Only if building is on/near easement
Submit Application + Fees	C7	\$0	\$0	\$0	Fee included in C1
LPHCP Compliance	C8	\$0	\$0	\$0	Carried over from development permit
Application Subtotal		\$1,000	\$3,500	\$2,000	

Phase D — Construction & Inspections

Task	Code	Low	High	Midpoint	Notes
Plan Review by County	D1	\$0	\$0	\$0	Included in application fee
Address Review Comments	D2	\$0	\$500	\$250	Architect/engineer revisions if needed
Building Permit Issuance	D3	\$0	\$0	\$0	Issued after plan review approval
Construction Inspections	D4	\$200	\$500	\$350	Foundation, framing, MEP, fire, insulation
Final Inspection	D5	\$0	\$0	\$0	Included in permit fees
Certificate of Occupancy	D6	\$0	\$0	\$0	Issued after final inspection
Inspection Subtotal		\$200	\$1,000	\$600	

Grand Total Summary

Category	Low	High	Midpoint
Design Professionals (Phase A)	\$9,100	\$19,500	\$13,400
Compliance & Technical (Phase B)	\$3,550	\$10,800	\$6,875
Application & Fees (Phase C)	\$1,000	\$3,500	\$2,000
Inspections (Phase D)	\$200	\$1,000	\$600
GRAND TOTAL	\$13,850	\$34,800	\$22,875

Important Notes

- All estimates are for Bastrop County / Central Texas area, March 2026.
- This cost estimate covers **permitting and design costs only** — actual construction costs are separate.
- "Midpoint" values are used in the building_permit_tasks tracking system.
- The architect fee (\$3K–\$6K) is the largest design cost — negotiate a package deal that includes MEP coordination.
- Several items carry over from the development permit at no additional cost (drainage plan, LPHCP, deed, etc.).
- TDLR registration is **mandatory** for all commercial construction in Texas — do not skip.
- Fire suppression requirements should be confirmed with BCESD #3 — small buildings may qualify for reduced requirements.
- Septic capacity verification is critical: the existing Jet J-500 (300 GPD) must support added bathroom fixtures.
- Construction costs (materials, labor, concrete, framing, plumbing, electrical, finishes) are **not included** in this estimate.

Sources

- Bastrop County Development Services Application Fees (official fee schedule PDF)
- Texas Department of Licensing & Regulation (TDLR) — Elimination of Architectural Barriers program
- International Building Code (IBC) 2021 — commercial construction requirements
- Central Texas architect, engineer, and MEP professional market rates (2025–2026)
- TCEQ OSSF requirements for commercial on-site sewage facilities